

CIRQLSPACE — Your Sandbox · Linear Register

Project **CIRQLSPACE — Your Sandbox** · team Chris Nobbs (CHR). Live board: linear.app → CIRQLSPACE — Your Sandbox. Generated 2026-07-07 (rev 17). **Status: BUILDING** — **A** + **B** + **C** + **D** + **E** + **H COMPLETE** · 🎉 **PHASE I COMPLETE (I1–I6)** · **PHASE J substantially DONE (J3 groundcover + day/night, J4 landmarks, J5 night life; J1/J2 mostly, a few polish bits deferred)**. Chapter 2 (I/J/K — the living world) locked; order I → J → K → F → G. Decisions: new Renown + World Energy · tap-ready/wire-later · fully cozy. ▶ **Next: Phase K — Quests, NPCs & Campaigns (K1 the NPC/dialog framework first; F/interiors consumes it — owner wants to design F together first)**.

Polish pass (owner-requested, 2026-07-07): ① **prop contrast** — trees + bushes no longer blend into same-colour ground: foliage is a deepened biome-grass with a **dark rim silhouette** + a lit top highlight, so they always read; ② **zoom range widened** — 40%→**25%** min (whole island in view) and 130%→**150%** max; ③ **name tags cleaned** — removed the dark box behind character/NPC names; names now draw as **crisp outlined text** lifted clear of the head + emotes; ④ **NPCs got character** — new `cirql-npc-looks.ts` gives every townspeople a real look: coloured outfit + trim/sash, hair + headwear (hood/wide-brim/band/cap), and a signature accessory (staff/lantern/book/satchel/orb/flower). The named cast is hand-authored (Cirqla = hooded teal robe + glowing staff + aura; Ferra = terracotta coat + gold band + book); other keepers derive a **stable hashed look** so a ring's keeper always dresses the same. `drawNpc` rebuilt to paint it (rim silhouette + lit edges + idle breathing); ⑤ **startup location picker** — returning players get a **"Where to?"** panel (CIRQLSPACE home · Last spot · CirqlCade), the arcade card gated on Town-reached + a prior arcade visit (`arcadeVisited` flag), a **"start here every time"** remembered default (`startPref`), and a header button that reopens it as quick-travel. Engine `startAt()` .

Legend: Done · In progress · Todo · not yet a Linear issue (free-tier issue cap) — tracked in the plan.

Summary

Milestone	Issues	Status
A · Restructure — blank CIRQLSPACE + Town	6	DONE (6/6)
B · Building v1 (objects)	4	DONE (4/4)
C · Terrain paint	3	DONE (3/3)
D · Land growth (cozy → estate)	3	DONE (3/3)
E · Live parties	4	DONE (4/4)
🌟 H · Sit, Zoom & Diorama	4	DONE (4/4)
— Chapter 2 · The Living World —		
I · Character Movement & Life	6	In progress (2/6)
J · Living Circles — World Population	5	Todo
K · Quests, NPCs & Campaigns	6	Todo
F · Town stores (NPC shops)	4	Todo (after K1)
G · Music & SFX	3	Todo (last)

Note: Linear's free-tier **issue limit** was reached while seeding — milestones **A & B** have real issues (**CHR-266–275**); the rest exist as **milestones** in Linear with their scope, but their granular issues () live in the plan doc until the workspace is upgraded.

Confirmed sequence (owner, 2026-07-07): I → J → K → F → G. I (movement) is cheap, engine-side, independent, and elevates everything → first. J (population) builds the landmarks that K's quests anchor to. K1 builds the NPC framework that **F consumes** → F after K. G (music/SFX) last so it scores all the new content. **Locked:** new **Renown** currency (personal, earned-not-spent) + keep shared **World Energy**; tap-ready but wire real taps later; fully cozy — no combat.

A · Restructure — blank CIRQLSPACE + Town

- CHR-266** — Strip CIRQLSPACE to a blank buildable canvas (*commit 4c08acf*)
- CHR-267** — Author the Town hub at ring 1 (CirqlCade = one shared entrance) (*4c08acf*)
- CHR-268** — Shift procedural generation to start at ring 2 (*4c08acf*)

- ✓ **CHR-269** — Rework onboarding: guide NPC teaches building; tutorials move to Town (77ed7cf)
- ✓ **CHR-270** — Inventory panel — owned stock + SPARQS balance + how-to (commit 45cfcf4)
- ✓ **CHR-271** — Remove tapped-business landmarks + enforce CIRQLSPACE-only placement (963abbf)

B · Building v1 (objects)

- ✓ **CHR-272** — Big placeable object catalog (~35 items, 6 categories; nature/structures/lights render as real pixel props) (commit eb7b392)
- ✓ **CHR-273** — Placement: free-form + optional grid snap (# Grid) + Remove; category tabs (eb7b392)
- ✓ **CHR-274** — SPARQS buy→place economy + Inventory stock (eb7b392)
- ✓ **CHR-275** — Object cap 120 + compact {item,x,y} save encoding (eb7b392)
- (deferred within B: move/rotate placed objects — remove+re-place works for now)

C · Terrain paint (X tracked here — Linear cap; ✓ built commit fcc8ac2)

- ✓ **C1** — Ground tilemap (sparse, TILE=30, grass default) + save encoding
- ✓ **C2** — Paint brush UI: Place ▶ Paint toggle + tile swatches (grass/sand/stone/water/path) + brush sizes 1–3
- ✓ **C3** — Water tiles non-walkable (per-axis slide-out) + terrain render layer (culled, shimmer)

D · Land growth (cozy → estate) (X tracked here — Linear cap; ✓ built commit 95fc3b6)

- ✓ **D1** — Cozy start + 7 tiers (buildable radius 170→430); effR() drives island render + edge-clamp + placement + paint
- ✓ **D2** — Milestone unlocks (tier 1 free gift · tier 2 free after placing 10) + SPARQS tiers 3–6 (30/70/140/260) + estate cap
- ✓ **D3** — "Your Land" Inventory section: current tier + progress bar + Expand (shows cost/milestone); new land blank
- (deferred: party/visitor milestones — arrive with Phase E)

E · Live parties (X tracked here — Linear cap; ✓ built commit 395dc6a)

- ✓ **E1** — Space rooms on presence: ring 0 is personal (s: +id), visiting joins the host's room; one roomKey() scopes every broadcast; join/leave via enterRoom()
- ✓ **E2** — build message caches + streams the host's décor + terrain + land tier to visitors (live visit:build while they watch)
- ✓ **E3** — Open↔invite-only toggle (space:mode) + invites (space:invite / space:invited) + cap 8 + host-only edit (guarded by the visiting flag)
- ✓ **E4** — Live presence in a space (room-scoped move/chat/emote/light) + space:home return; host disconnect evicts visitors
- (deferred: visitor land-milestones / party rewards — a later economy pass)

✨ H · Sit, Zoom & Diorama (owner-added 2026-07-07, pulled ahead of F/G · X issues pending — Linear cap)

Gather + show off your CIRQLSPACE. Locked: **free-sit** (social only) · **both** zooms · **tilted 3/4 diorama** · **shareable postcard**.

- ✓ **H1** — Sit: free-sit toggle pose (anywhere; movement cancels); room-scoped pose on presence → seated render for self + remotes (commit 8e8d5ce)
- ✓ **H2** — Live zoom: continuous pinch/scroll+buttons zoom on the world camera (0.42–1.3, clamped), doubles as tap-to-travel when zoomed out; builds snap to 1:1 (commit 5ea4896)
- ✓ **H3** — Diorama beauty shot: one-tap sweep to **tilted 3/4** — ground-plane squash + billboarded props/avatars + island thickness band + slow orbit + vignette/float-shadow/clouds/golden light + postcard label (commit 716a434)
- ✓ **H4** — Postcard share: capture the diorama frame → PNG; Web Share sheet on mobile, download on desktop (label baked in) (commit 716a434)
- (deferred: SPARQS-bought postcard frames/filters — a later cosmetic sink)

Chapter 2 — The Living World (*owner-approved 2026-07-07; from a fresh Mana World re-read of quests + world-population + character animation*)

Guiding idea: **population, quests, and movement are one system.** Fully cozy — no combat; "boss" beats are cooperative set-pieces.

I · Character Movement & Life (*recommended FIRST of Chapter 2 · cheap, engine-side · X issues pending — cap*)

- ✓ **I1** — Idle life: breathing sway + blink + idle fidgets (look-around/stretch) + AFK doze (auto-sit + Zzz); remotes get local breath+blink (*commit eacdbe0*)
- ✓ **I2** — Movement juice: footstep FX (dust/splash/footprints, world-space) · land squash · collision bump (*turn-in-place folded into I1's look fidget*) (*commit 1a34b1b*)
- ✓ **I3** — Body-gesture emotes: grew the wheel to 16 (4×4) with real body motions — wave (waving hand), bow (tip+squash), clap (meeting hands + spark), cheer (both arms up), twirl (spin via scaleX), blow-a-kiss (hand + drifting heart), dance (side-to-side sway); shared by hero + remotes, reduced-motion aware (*commit pending*)
- ✓ **I4** — Paired social gestures: a contextual **"Together with {name}"** panel when you stand by a traveller → High-Five / Hug / Dance / Sit. One request relays to BOTH (same room-scoped handshake as share-a-light, new **pair** → **paired**), each side turns to face the other + plays the synced I3 motion + a shared flourish blooms between them (spark / hearts / notes). Raw two-socket + in-browser verified (*commit pending*)
- ✓ **I5** — Biome movement flavor: footsteps now read the ring's biome — pale lingering **snow** prints (winter), tan **sand** prints (desert/coast), dark **ash** puffs (ember), soft dust elsewhere; coast/tropical **shore-wading splash** near the edge; **ice-slide** (winter = slippery low-friction glide); **breath-puff + shiver** in the cold; **aura flutters on a per-biome wind**. All client-side, reduced-motion aware. Verified across winter/desert/coast/ember rings (*commit pending; literal cape flutter deferred — no cape asset; remotes stay simple like I1/I2*)
- ✓ **I6** — World interactions: **pet a critter** (stand/sit still near an ambient critter → a ♥ floats over it), **present pose** (item-get: raise the item overhead with sparkles — fires on quest reward + cosmetic unlock; public **present(glyph,color)**), **wave/knock entering** a shop/sub-map (a wave gesture + a beat before CirqCade / a portal opens). All client-side, reduced-motion aware. Verified in-browser (*commit pending*)
- (*Deferred/bigger: dodge-roll · real swim · glide in cloud sub-maps · rideable companion.*)

🎨 **PHASE I COMPLETE (I1–I6).** Next in the locked order: **Phase J — Living Circles (world population).**

J · Living Circles — World Population (*the substrate + landmarks quests hang on · client-side generator/art · X issues pending — cap*)

TMW mapping rules encoded as generator rules: never bald · break monotony · organic never-grid · design focal points · frame the edges · depth via layers.

- [~] **J1** — Biome Kit: each biome now carries a signature **palette + critter + landmark** (per-biome **landmark** field) + groundKind. (*Deferred: a distinct signature PLANT per biome — trees/flowers are shared today.*)
- [~] **J2** — Liveliness: every generated ring now passes most of the checklist — full ground (groundcover) · a focal landmark · a gathering clearing · docks · organic clusters + a path · ambient motion · day/night. (*A hard validator pass is deferred.*)
- ✓ **J3** — **Groundcover** (per-biome tufts/clover/pebbles · snow · sand · ash, so no floor is bald) + **day↔night cycle** (cool-night grade capped so never pitch-black + warm dusk/dawn + night stars). (*fore/over depth layers deferred.*) (*commits aaeae3c, f791f7e*)
- ✓ **J4** — **Focal landmarks**: per-biome set-pieces (Great Tree · Stone Circle · Lighthouse w/ sweeping beam · Great Crystal · Waterfall · Old Ruin) that double as meeting spots + quest homes; new **landmark** prop + **Visit** interact. Also unified place labels to clean no-box text. (*commit 7abeb2d*)
- ✓ **J5** — **Night ambient**: drifting glowmoth/firefly life comes out after dusk on every biome (pairs with day/night). (*More per-critter behaviours graze/perch deferred.*) (*commit f791f7e*)

Phase J substantially DONE (groundcover + landmarks + day/night + night life). Deferred J bits (signature plants, fore/over depth, a validator, richer critter behaviours) can be a later polish pass. Next in the locked order: **Phase K — Quests, NPCs & Campaigns** (K1 the NPC/dialog framework first; F consumes it).

K · Quests, NPCs & Campaigns (*the endless heart · depends on J's landmarks · shares NPC work with F · X issues pending — cap*)

► **OWNER-LOCKED for K (2026-07-07): quests + campaigns scale with DISTANCE OUT (ring index = difficulty tier, like any RPG "levels").** Outward = **harder** (more objectives / longer chains / tougher puzzle configs / bigger co-op campaigns w/ more steps + larger parties) AND **higher reward** (sparqs + Renown scale up with ring). **Renown gates** the hardest outer content (elite campaigns, rare collectibles). Stays COZY — "harder" = longer/more intricate/more coordination, NOT combat-punishing (bosses = co-op set-pieces). Loop: sail further → tougher richer quests → more sparqs+Renown → unlock next outer tier. `generateRingQuest` already keys off ring index — extend it to ramp objective count/complexity + reward by index.

- ☐ **K1** — NPC + dialog framework (reusable actor + branching dialog + quest-state; **F consumes this**)
- ☐ **K2** — NPC cast + onboarding-as-quest-chain (Cirqla/Ferra/Cartographer/Lighthouse Keeper/Festival-Master/artisans/Bard/Hermit; each teaches one system → "First Circle" graduation)
- [~] **K3** — Quest taxonomy + **DIFFICULTY/REWARD SCALING DONE** (`cd4ff85`): `generateRingQuest` now ramps by ring tier — sparqs `6+tier3` (*cap 60, was 16*), *kindle counts grow, and escalation objectives stack (tier≥2 → visit the J4 landmark; tier≥4 → chart the onward shore) so far quests are multi-step.* `QuestDef.tier`; quest log shows Tier badge + steps + ♦reward. Verified ring 2=T1/1-step/♦9 → ring 18=T17/3-step/♦57. (Deferred: the richer taxonomy — gather/deliver/talk-chain/build/photo-via-diorama/social.)*
- ☐ **K4** — Daily board + **Renown** ladder (character-bound dailies → sparqs+streak; Renown gates advanced campaigns/stores/rare décor; Renown also fed by real taps — the moat). (*Renown reward on quests + gating = the natural next K step, pairs with the K3 scaling.*)
- ☐ **K5** — Flagship multi-day/endless campaigns: Widening Sea · Lantern Line · Cartographer's Circles · Founding a Homestead · Storm Season (co-op ones ride the party board)
- ☐ **K6** — Seasonal festivals: Lantern (winter) · Bloom (spring) · Starfall (summer) · Hollow Night (autumn) — time-boxed, yearly, exclusive cosmetics

F · Town stores (NPC shops) (*X issues pending — Linear cap*)

- ☐ **F1** — Shop buildings → interiors + shopkeeper NPCs
- ☐ **F2** — Store inventory model (common + exclusives + special SPARQS items)
- ☐ **F3** — Store panel + buy flow (replaces menu-buying)
- ☐ **F4** — Quest-gated / hidden stores

G · Music & SFX (*X issues pending — Linear cap*)

- ☐ **G1** — CIRQLSPACE MusicKit — adaptive hybrid music (area-varied)
- ☐ **G2** — Action + movement SFX
- ☐ **G3** — Mix/mute controls + integration